

Finance Committee Meeting September 30, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qRKKS8rkPX8
Publication Date	2026-09-30T23:34:32Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Finance Committee of the Muncie Common Council Budget Work Session (00:00:13).
- **Summary of Discussion:** Opening committee session focusing on interviewing department heads regarding their proposed departmental budgets. The committee chair (Dale Basham) outlined the review process, noting that public comments on the budget would be reserved for the full Common Council meeting when the budget is considered for final action.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Called to order at 00:00:00 as a meeting of the Finance Committee of the Muncie Common Council by Chair Dale Basham.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dale Basham (Chair), William McIntosh, Jerry Dishman.
 - **Staff / Officials Recognized:** Lacey Jones (City Clerk's Office), Amber Green & Caleb Robbins (Communications/Live Stream), Brandon Murphy & Patrick Wright (Attorneys, Cannon, Runs, and Murphy), Josh Talby (Animal Shelter), Matt Wigley (City Controller), Taylor Beard (Prairie Creek), Troy Waters (Beach Grove Cemetery), Patty Gustin (Human Resources).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening invocation and Pledge of Allegiance (00:00:00).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not discussed during this committee segment.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:24 Muncie Animal Care and Services Department Budget Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Josh Talby, Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Director Talby reviewed the department's operations, noting they handle all animal control and shelter operations in Muncie and unincorporated township areas. The department operates at roughly 105% capacity (350<U+2013>400 animals in care). Talby noted 5% salary increases for employees (slightly higher for the office manager). Committee members questioned high line-item usage in part-time labor (121%), office supplies, medical/food/litter, auto repairs (due to aging 2014 fleet), and building maintenance (notably a \$41,000 hit for replacing a 20-ton HVAC unit after a breakdown). Committee members suggested looking into shifting some part-time positions into full-time roles.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken at this stage.
- **00:23:14 Controller<U+2013>s Office Budget Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Wigley, City Controller.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Controller Wigley presented the controller's office budget, noting the only increase requested was for standard 5% salary/benefit adjustments and an increased surety bond cost for the deputy controller to match liability levels. Discussion covered accounts payable, payroll, grants, audits, state reporting, IT service provider transitions, and improving monthly budget performance reporting for city boards and departments.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken at this stage.
- **00:05:02 Prairie Creek Reservoir Department Budget Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Taylor Beard, General Manager.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** General Manager Taylor Beard reported on the park's operations, noting the sole budget increase is a 5% payroll increase. Discussion covered the transition of Prairie Creek into its own department separate from parks, modernization efforts away from paper/pencil tracking, laboratory testing costs, and a drop in electricity expenses due to the campground closure. Committee members

expressed concern and questioned the timeline regarding the closed campground and lost revenue (~\$350,000).

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken at this stage.
- **00:56:06 Beach Grove Cemetery Department Budget Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Troy Waters, Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Superintendent Troy Waters discussed operations at Beach Grove Cemetery (founded in 1841). The budget reflects standard 5% salary adjustments and adjustments to part-time labor. Discussion highlighted historic preservation efforts (stone fence repairs, chapel restoration/rentals), severe storm/flood damages (north end flooding, well damage, pond liner issues), and tree removal work handled primarily in-house.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken at this stage.
- **01:20:41 City Council Budget Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Wigley (presenting on behalf of Council President Green).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed line items including the City Council Ethics Commission (\$3,000) and salary appropriations. Clarified that a 5% salary increase is included for council positions should the council choose to take it.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken at this stage.
- **01:23:58 Human Resources Department Budget Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Patty Gustin, Director of Human Resources.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Director Gustin outlined HR operations supporting 387 current city employees (340 full-time, 45 part-time/seasonal). Gustin noted a department staff size of three, standard 5% salary increases, and minor internal reallocations of postage funds toward telephone, other services/charges, and subscriptions to modernize operations.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken at this stage.
- **01:34:57 Finance Committee Recommendation on the Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Committee Chair Dale Basham / Finance Committee.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A motion was made and seconded to issue a favorable recommendation on the proposed city budget.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Recorded roll call vote not formally conducted; motion carried unanimously by voice/oral assent).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public comment period or citizen forum took place during this committee work session; public comment was explicitly restricted to the subsequent full Common Council meeting per opening remarks at [00:00:28](#).)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None beyond department presentations.
 - **Adjournment:** Official adjournment by voice vote at [01:34:41](#).
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